

Jan Horak

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FOUNDING FULL-STACK ENGINEER & TECHNICAL TEAM LEAD

A multilingual Software Engineer and hands-on Technical Lead with 15+ years of international leadership, team management, and cross-functional collaboration experience. Proven track record of architecting scalable web and mobile ecosystems, directing technical infrastructure for startup ventures, and mentoring high-performing engineering teams. Analytical problem-solver specializing in clean, optimized codebase engineering, real-time data sync, and multi-platform solution delivery.

SKILLS & EXPERTISE

- **Languages:** JavaScript (ES6+), TypeScript, Python, Java, SQL
- **Frameworks & Libraries:** React, React Native, Next.js, Node.js, Express, Django, Flask, Vue, jQuery
- **Cloud & Infrastructure:** Firebase, Google Cloud, AWS (S3), Vercel, Netlify, NoSQL (MongoDB), Git
- **Leadership & Strategy:** Agile Sprint Management, Technical Architecture, Instructional Feedback & Mentorship
- **Core Competencies:** API Integration (Stripe Connect, Web Speech, Words API), Algorithmic Optimization
- **Languages Spoken:** Fluent in English and German

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Primary Founding Engineer | [Bookends Marketplace](#) | 03/2023 – Present

- **Full-Stack Architecture:** Directed technical infrastructure choices, end-to-end software architecture, and complete development lifecycle documentation for a scalable startup ecosystem.
- **Cross-Platform Mobile Launch:** Engineered, optimized, and successfully deployed a native, cross-platform mobile application utilizing React Native, publishing to both the Apple App Store and Google Play Store.
- **Web Marketplace Ecosystem:** Designed and launched a production-grade Next.js marketplace website deployed via Vercel, implementing enhanced bulk-posting capabilities and a seamless user experience.
- **Cloud Infrastructure & Security:** Architected and maintained the relational/NoSQL hybrid Firebase real-time database schema and secure cloud storage buckets to handle low-latency data and user asset uploads.
- **Payment Integration & Growth Strategy:** Fully integrated Stripe Connect for robust vendor onboarding, payouts, and encrypted checkouts; spearheaded recent 2026 initiatives focusing on technical SEO optimization and future platform expansion goals.

Lead Instructor / Senior Instructional Associate | General Assembly | 09/2022 – 06/2026

- **Lead Instructor (Spring 2026 – June 2026):** Promoted to spearhead and instruct an intensive IT Bootcamp, successfully training career changers for CompTIA A+ and Network+ Certification exams.
- **Classroom Leadership:** Cultivated a productive, high-engagement learning environment for over 250+ students across 22 cohorts through the strategic application of adult learning theories.
- **Instructional Feedback & Mentorship:** Delivered comprehensive instructional feedback, code reviews, and technical guidance to students mastering JavaScript, Python, Django, and React.
- **Sprint Troubleshooting:** Guided students through fast-paced project week sprints, diagnosing and unblocking architectural and debugging issues in real time.

TECHNICAL PROJECT EXPERIENCE

[Letter-Box Solver](#) | React, JavaScript ES6, CSS3

- Engineered a high-performance puzzle-solving tool for the NYT *Letter Boxed* game, serving an active user base averaging **5,000+ monthly users**.
- Optimized dictionary-parsing search algorithms, migrating away from memory-intensive iterations to ultra-fast client-side lookups designed specifically for mobile hardware limitations.

EDUCATION

- **Software Engineering Immersive** | General Assembly | US Remote | 2021
- **Systems Integration & Software Development** | Taylorix Institute | Germany | 2020
- **Theological Studies** | University of Heidelberg | Germany